AIRPORTS BECAME HALLMARK OF UP, NEW 'FLIGHT' OF DEVELOPMENT TOOK OFF

Noida international airport will be a major centre for maintenance, repair and operation of aeroplanes. An MRO (maintenance repair and overhaul) station is being constructed here in 40 acres area for the maintenance, repair and overhauling of aeroplanes.

The first phase of Noida international airport will be completed by year 2024. Rupees 30000 crores will be invested in it. The airport will generate avenues of 1 lakh jobs and will further attract investment of around 60000 crore rupees. Uttar Pradesh will become first state in the country with five international airports and 21 airports.

Under the guidance of Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath, the UDAN scheme is being implemented effectively in the state. Before 2017 there were only two functional airports in Uttar Pradesh while now 9 airports are functioning, 8 airports are almost ready while work is going on swiftly on four airports.

On 28 October, Prime Minister Narendra Modi, in presence of Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath, inaugurated Kushinagar international airport. On the same day, first international flight landed in Kushinagar and 100 Buddhist monks along with 25 member delegation came from Shrilanka.

The runway of Kushinagar airport is longest among the aeroplane stationing airports functioning in Uttar Pradesh. Length of its runway is 3200 metres and and width is 45 meters. In terms of the length of the runway Varanasi international airport comes on second place.

The Kushinagar district which was neglected for almost seven decades after independence, is now emerging as India's cultural ambassador for the world. With the landing of first passenger plane on 26 November at the Kushinagar airport, a golden chapter added in the development journey of Uttar Pradesh.

The Kushinagar international airport situated at the mahpariNirvan sthali of lord Buddha, has given direct air connectivity to more than a dozen South East Asian countries including Sri Lanka, Japan, China, Taiwan, South Korea, Thailand, Singapore, Vietnam along with ASEAN countries.

Work is going on to start sea plane service on Varanasi-Gorakhpur- Varanasi route. This will be the first sea plane route in Uttar Pradesh. Plan is to link other famous religious districts like Prayagraj, Ayodhya, Mathura, Chitrakoot through sea plane service apart from Varanasi and Gorakhpur.

Before 2017, the air connectivity in Uttar Pradesh was limited to 15 to 16 cities only. Today there are direct flights to more than 75 cities, from airports in state. This became possible because of UDAN scheme.

EXPANDING AIR CONNECTIVITY

FUNCTIONAL			IN WAITING		
• Lucknow	• Gorakhpur	• Kanpur	• Ayodhya	• Chitrakoot	
• Agra	• Prayagraj	• Bareilly	• Shravasti	• Moradabad	• Aligarh
• Varanasi	• Hindan	• Kushinagar	• Azamgarh	• Sonbhadra	• Jhansi

PLANS ARE READY

• Meerut • Saharanpur • Lalitpur • Ghazipur

